temperatures of the sole plate. Setting dial is generally marked with the nature of fabric to set temperature.

Most Appropriate Sole Plate Temperature for Ironing of different Fabric	
Fabric	**Temperature Range**
Linen	191 – 218°C
Cotton	163 – 191°C
Rayon	135 – 163°C
Wool	Below 135°C

Care and Precautions

- Always unplug the iron after use.
- When not in use, it should be positioned on the heel rest. The cord should be wound loosely around the handle.
- Use only distilled water in the water chamber of 'steam and dry irons'.
- Do not use steam iron for dry materials which require pre-dampening. Fabric laundered with starch, most linens, heavy cottons and some medium and heavy weight linen require pre-dampening.
- Do not operate the control knobs unnecessarily.
- Spray-nozzle must be cleaned only according to the manufacturer's instruction.

5.4.2 Ironing Board and Sleeve Board

These facilitate ironing of clothing. The ironing board is a horizontal flat board. It is supported on crossed leg frame. The board is padded with flannel it is covered with white cotton or linen cover which is stretched and smooth while ironing. This is generally made of wood but may also be of aluminium or other metal. On one end of the board is a square or rectangular area with an asbestos sheet base. This is used to place iron when hot during ironing. The ironing boards are collapsible and easy to be moved. It requires a very limited space for storage. These are very useful for ironing of skirts with numerous gathers. It is also known as "Skirt-boards". Similarly, "Sleeve-board" is useful for ironing of coat sleeves. These also have padded surface similar to that of ironing boards, but is smaller in size. The board has one open end and is supported on the solid wooden platform through vertical support.



Figure 5.20 Ironing Board



What does starch do to clothes?

For aesthetic purposes, starch is commonly used when dry cleaning clothes to leave them feeling and looking crisp, somewhat stiff, and free of any wrinkles. Starch protects the fabric from stains by sealing the individual clothing fibres. It can also protect clothes that can't be washed with water. It extends the length of the time between dry clean visits. Typically, someone can wear an article of clothing two or three times before needing it to be dry cleaned again.



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